

I attempted a live IBKR pull (contract search, positions, option parameters) to avoid inheriting the benches' tape and to settle the options-chain question directly. **Both calls were denied — permission isn't granted in this non-interactive session**, so the chain question stays open and is carried as a drainable item rather than assumed. All tape below is the benches' live reads, attributed as such.

PITCH — KRZ.ID — VERDICT

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION — both benches land on reject at zero size and both argue the idea should be retired rather than shelved; this deck is written so the adjudicator can rule against that, not to be filled.

What we believe

The original idea was simple. Taking the alcohol out of beer breaks the drink in ways that are hard to fix, so every non-alcoholic launch has to buy a repair kit. Non-alcoholic drinks are one of the few genuinely growing corners of a flat beverage market. So instead of guessing which brand wins, buy the company that sells the repair kit to all of them — and Kerry, a €13.4bn Irish taste-and-nutrition supplier, was our candidate.

The science holds up. Alcohol is not just a flavour; it is the solvent that decides which aromas escape into the air above the glass. Remove it and the liquid becomes more water-like: the fruity notes leave too readily and the cereal-like “wet grain” compounds stay behind and dominate. You cannot fix this by adding the original flavours back at the original dose, because the dose-to-perception relationship has moved. That is a real formulation problem, and it was the strongest support the idea ever had ([Foods 2021](#), [full text read](#)).

What we believe **after** court is different, and it is not a matter of degree. The repair kit is mostly cheap. The published fixes are glycerol, mineral salts, malt extract and a different yeast strain — commodities and a strain licence, not a flavour house's intellectual property ([Membranes 2023](#)). And the layer is too small to matter to a company this size. Hand Kerry a worldwide monopoly on every flavour-side repair sold into every non-alcoholic beer, competitors erased, and it buys roughly €18–55m of profit against a €15.6bn enterprise value — a 1.5–4.7% move in a stock that trades 1.3% on an average day.

The defence bench then made it worse for us, and this is the finding that ends the case. Rebuilding the market by physical volume rather than by retail value: world beer output is about 1.896bn hectolitres, non-alcoholic is ~2.3% of that today and heading to ~4% by 2028, so roughly 76m hectolitres. For the position to be worth a 50% re-rate, Kerry would have to collect **€20.5 of**

flavour ingredients per hectolitre of beer, worldwide, forever — somewhere between a third and two-thirds of the entire raw-material cost of making the beer. That is not a hard number to hit. It is a physically impossible one.

So what we believe is: the mechanism is real, the money is not, and no amount of further research changes that.

What the market believes

The market believes Kerry is a decent, slightly dull ingredients compounder having an ordinary year. Analysts model FY26 revenue of €6.83bn (+1.1%) and €5.10 of earnings, FY27 €7.16bn (+4.8%) and €5.64 — twelve analysts covering, average target €97.25 against €84.25, range €81–€111, thirteen buys and six holds. First-half results showed volumes up 3.3%, profit margin up 0.6 points to 16.7%, with management pointing at a 2030 goal of 3–5% volume growth and a 20–21% margin ([H1 2026 results](#)).

Nobody is arguing about non-alcoholic beer, because nobody thinks it moves Kerry's numbers. On the arithmetic, they are right.

Why we might have edge

Honestly stated, and then honestly withdrawn:

- **The science is genuinely under-appreciated.** Most people assume de-alcoholised beer is beer minus alcohol. It is beer minus alcohol *minus a biased slice of its aroma*, with a biased slice returned — the recovered condensate in the peer-reviewed run came back at 38.7% alcohol while the aroma sat in a separate water fraction, and only some compounds transferred (esters well, higher alcohols at 3.5%). Knowing that ahead of the crowd is a real informational advantage about the category.
- **Kerry does not disclose by end-use market.** Its segments are geographic only — Americas €1,818m, Europe €687m, Asia-Pacific/Middle East/Africa €831m — so no one can see a non-alcoholic line even if one exists. Management did attribute beverage volume growth partly to “low/no alcohol solutions through integrated taste” on the July call, with no number attached. Opacity sometimes hides an asset.

Neither survives. Being right about the chemistry earns nothing if the chemistry's whole addressable spend, captured entirely, is a rounding error on the enterprise value. And the opacity cuts the other way: what is hidden is at most ~0.7% of revenue, so there is nothing large enough behind the curtain to be worth the search.

Why it might be priced in

“Priced in” is the wrong frame here, and saying so plainly is more useful than pretending otherwise. This is not a case where the market has already discounted our insight. It is a case where our insight, if fully correct, would change the forecast by **+0.02 to +0.06 percentage points of group**

growth — inside the rounding error of any analyst's model. We agree with the consensus not because we lost the argument but because there is no arithmetic route from our thesis to a different number.

The tape adds nothing to buy either: €84.25, only 5.6% below the 52-week high, 31% above the low, above both the 50-day (€83.11) and 200-day (€75.69) averages. This is a well-owned, well-covered, well-followed large cap with no dislocation. That conditions size and timing; it is not what kills the idea.

What could go wrong

Failure one — we buy the label and own the company. We take a position on a non-alcoholic thesis and end up owning 99.4%-plus ordinary Kerry: a food-ingredients business growing revenue ~1% at ~15.7x forward earnings. Volumes soften, the margin ratchet stalls short of the 2030 goal, the multiple compresses toward the low end of its history, and we lose 15–25% on a business we did no work on. *Tripwire: monitorable* — group volume growth, EBITDA margin trend, and the FY guidance line at the Q3 update and full-year results.

Failure two — the rejection is right and also expensive. We are correct that non-alcoholic beer is immaterial, we retire the ticket, and Kerry compounds anyway: +15.4% to the average target, volumes +3.3%, margin +60bps, buybacks against a share count that already fell ~2.9m on the dairy transaction (completion RNS). We lose the money we did not make, and worse, we lose it *because of how our own process is wired* — a rejection stamped on this ticket becoming an informal blacklist on the name. *Tripwire: monitorable, but only by us* — the fix is procedural, and both benches said it explicitly: the compounder case must open its own file with its own profitability test and must never inherit this one.

Failure three — the one with no tripwire. The arithmetic is right, we still lose, and we never see it coming, because the thing that decides it is invisible by construction. Kerry is an EU-domiciled business-to-business supplier whose commercial work sits entirely under non-disclosure agreements. It reports segments by geography, discloses no customer above 10%, files no US quarterly report (Irish issuer, no SEC filings), and — the part that matters — its relevant shipments are Europe-to-Europe, so the customs-manifest tool that would normally identify a supplier's customers is *structurally blind here*, not merely unrun. The defence bench recorded that as a standing gap for this whole class of issuer, not a Kerry-specific miss.

Name the unknown-unknown class: **contract-perimeter opacity at a business-to-business supplier with no end-use disclosure and no observable customer channel.** Anything that lives inside a private supply contract — an exclusivity we cannot see, a per-customer systems deal, a repricing, a loss of a large account, or an acquisition that buys the capability we said was absent — can move this stock with zero advance signal available to us. There is no sensor to arm. There is no filing that carries it. We would learn about it from the price.

The reflexive and structural leg. Liquidity is not our problem: about €14.2m trades a day, so a disciplined ladder at 1% of daily volume is roughly €142k a day and a full slot fills inside one session. We would not be pushing the price around and we would not be bidding into flow we

ourselves created. The real reflexivity is in our own rulebook. Our default says a court that produces no *named* kill owes a minimum starter position — so the difference between “we found nothing wrong” and “we found three specific things wrong” is the difference between mechanically owning this and correctly owning none of it. The defence bench was explicit that flat was *earned* by three named novel kills, not defaulted into. If a future reviewer softens those tags, the rulebook manufactures a position nobody wants. Two other defaults are also live and both are switched off here: the fair-price entry default does not apply because the kill is on the size of the prize, not the price; and the small pay-up allowance does not apply because there is no verified fairness to pay up against.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that we never owned the thesis we bought — the non-alcoholic layer is under 1% of Kerry, so the profit and loss would be settled by the 99%-plus food-ingredients business we did no work on, and settled against us by exactly the volume and mix deceleration this ticket never examined.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Removing alcohol strips aroma and needs a recovery step	Full text read, <i>Foods</i> 2021	40 mbar / 36 °C; beer 5.28% → 0.17% alcohol; condensate 38.74%; selective ester recovery	Yes
Membrane route needs commodity add-backs	Full text read, <i>Membranes</i> 2023	15–18% extract lost, ~80% sodium/potassium depleted; panel needed glycerol + mineral salts	Yes
Exact aroma-partition magnitudes (32–39% vs 8–12% retention; glycerol cutting release ~40%)	Attempted both primary papers	Blocked — one returned metadata only, one hit a login wall; numbers are from secondary renderings	No — direction uncontested, magnitudes unconfirmed (item 3 below)
A yeast route avoids the equipment entirely	Vendor pages + peer-reviewed	Maltose-negative strains (White Labs WLP618, Novonesis SmartBev NEER) cap alcohol near 0.5% with no capex	Yes
Kerry publicly offers a non-alcoholic beer system	Read Kerry’s own alcohol and brewing pages	No de-alcoholisation, no NA beer named; its NA platform is a 2020 <i>spirits</i> botanicals range	Absence confirmed — but see bench error below
Beverage is growing inside the group	Interim report arithmetic	$922.9/3,336.4 = 27.66\%$ vs $957.7/3,463.1 = 27.65\%$; beverage -3.63% vs group -3.66%	Yes — and it means nothing. Flat share is consistent with NA growing while coffee/dairy fell. No signal, not a disproof
Prize size by share-of-retail	Attack bench: 0.5–1.5% of a ~\$24bn category	\$120–360m globally for all suppliers; Kerry at 100% = 1.5–4.7% of enterprise value	Yes

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Prize size by physical volume (independent method)	Defence bench: 1.896bn hL × 2.3% → 4%	~43.6m hL today, ~76m hL by 2028; +50% requires €20.5/hL	Yes — two methods, same answer
Kerry holds non-alcoholic beer patents	Patent tool, five runs	All five failed on HTTP 503 — a tool outage, not a negative result	No. Both benches refused to rest any finding on Kerry's zeros, in either direction
Bench error — attack bench cited a “pack-derived 13.23x” multiple	Defence bench recomputed	The evidence pack contained no filings and no financials at all; the correct figure from the bench's own inputs is 14.0x . A provenance attribution to an empty source	Corrected. Error favours the thesis by ~6%; verdict unmoved
Bench error — attack bench said “15 analysts”	Defence bench re-pulled the forecast page	12 analysts. Revenue and EPS estimates confirmed verbatim; headcount wrong	Corrected; immaterial
Bench error — attack bench graded “Kerry is the wrong horse” as refuted	Defence bench	Website silence is a weak instrument for a supplier whose work is under NDA, and the corroborating patent register was down. Should be “plausible”, not “confirmed”	Downgraded and excluded from the kill tally
Bench error — attack bench mislabelled its consensus agreement as a novel finding	Defence bench	“Our number equals the street's” is by definition agreement with consensus	Re-tagged
Bench error — attack bench left a false re-entry trigger	Defence bench built the per-hectolitre table	Attack bench said >€5/hL “puts the monopoly case near +20%”. The table says 12.2% . It under-sold its own kill and armed a trigger its arithmetic does not support	Deleted. This is the most consequential bench error in the court
Bench error — neither bench looked at the adjacent business first	Defence bench swept it late	The third class-inherent defect in NA beer is <i>microbiological</i> : alcohol is a preservative, and NA beer with leftover sugar has neither alcohol nor low pH (JASBC 2025). Kerry runs a named food-protection franchise. Best available save for the thesis — and the attack bench never tested it	Tested and failed at Kerry's own primary : its beverage-preservation page names soft drinks, waters, electrolyte drinks — no beer, no alcohol
Evidence pack said the stock was 52% off its low	Defence bench audited both	The pack returned no tape at all , so its 52% figure had	Pack field is the artifact; benches credited

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
		no source. The benches' live read of +31% is correct	
Is there a near-term event to trade around?	IR calendar read	H1 reported 29 Jul 2026; no Q3 date published. Ex-dividend 8 Oct 2026 (€1.40) is a corporate action, not news	Confirmed: nothing within five trading days

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

No entry. No starter. No ladder. No watch on the non-alcoholic premise. Size: zero. This is not “wait for a better price” — the kill is on the size of the prize, so no price makes the thesis work. A cheaper Kerry would be a *different* case about a food-ingredients compounder, and it must be filed as one.

Reopen bands (all three must be read together):

1. **Disclosure gate — the only real one.** Kerry discloses, or investor relations confirms in writing, non-alcohol-exposed revenue at **≥2% of group (≥€137m on FY26 revenue of €6.83bn) growing at ≥2x group**. One number settles the whole court. The defence bench's position, which we adopt: the arithmetic says that number does not exist to be disclosed, so treat this as a formality rather than an expectation.
2. **Unit-economics gate — deliberately set where the arithmetic actually bites.** A brewer's bill of materials showing flavour-house-addressable add-back spend **≥€10/hL** for non-alcoholic versus conventional beer. Not the €5/hL the attack bench proposed: €5 returns 12.2% of enterprise value even under a worldwide monopoly, which is not a position. Even €10 only returns 24.4%. **Note plainly that this gate reopens a look, not a buy.**
3. **Capability gate.** A named non-alcoholic beer or spirit brand publicly attributing its formulation to a Kerry system — currently zero such attributions exist.

Catalyst dates, for the record and not as triggers: ex-dividend **8 Oct 2026** (€1.40, ~1.66% yield, a corporate action); a Q3 trading update **inferred at early-Nov 2026 but with no published date — this must not be used as a catalyst by anyone reading this deck**; EU “alcohol-free ≤0.5% / 0.0% ≤0.05%” labelling rules already in force since **18 Mar 2026**; reduced-alcohol aromatised wine labelling from **19 Sep 2027**; Ireland's health-warning labels **deferred from May 2026 to Sep 2028** — a date any frozen research file still carries wrongly.

If a separate compounder case is opened (different ticket, different court, its own profitability test): reference tape is €84.25, 50-day €83.11, 200-day €75.69, 52-week €64.30–€89.25, target range €81–€111. Euro-funded; Irish dividend withholding tax documentation required before any dividend is received.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- dated pack KRZ.IDI2026-10-08: KRZ.ID: Ex-dividend EUR1.40 (~1.66% yield) - corporate action, not a print; Irish DWT documentation would apply (date confirmed=True)
- dated pack KRZ.IDI2026-11-05: KRZ.ID: Q3 trading update INFERRED at early-Nov; NO date published on Kerry's IR calendar - must not be used as a catalyst (date confirmed=F
- dated pack KRZ.IDI2027-09-19: KRZ.ID: EU reduced-alcohol aromatised wine labelling rules apply (date confirmed=True)
- dated pack KRZ.IDI2028-09-01: KRZ.ID: Ireland Public Health (Alcohol) Act health-warning labels, deferred from 22 May 2026 (date confirmed=True)

What remains unverified

1. **Flavour-house-addressable add-back spend per hectolitre in a real brewer's bill of materials.** The single load-bearing number in the entire case. Private commercial data; not drainable. *Estimate: €2.5–7.6/hL*, reached by inverting the attack bench's retail-share market size against the defence bench's volume base, and consistent with the peer-reviewed repair list being glycerol, mineral salts and yeast. Probability it exceeds the €20.5/hL needed for the position to pay: **~2%**.
2. **Kerry's non-alcohol-exposed revenue as a share of group.** Not disclosed; segments are geographic only; no end-use margin exists in any filing. *Estimate: 0.24–0.72% of FY26 revenue (€16–49m)*, from the market-size arithmetic times a realistic share against Givaudan, IFF, Symrise, Döhler and BarthHaas. Probability it is $\geq 2\%$ of group: **~5%**.
3. **The aroma-partition magnitudes behind the "wet grain" defect** (32–39% vs 8–12% retention; glycerol at 4.5% cutting headspace release by ~40%). Both primary papers blocked — one served metadata only, one redirected to an institutional login. Drainable with library access. *Estimate: direction is uncontested in the literature; magnitudes within $\pm 30\%$ of the secondary rendering, probability 0.8.* Not load-bearing on the verdict.
4. **The 2026 category review** (*Foods*, "Non-Alcoholic and Low-Alcohol Beer...") — the publisher returned a 403 to us; content taken from the indexed abstract. Drainable now with a full browser fingerprint on the request.
5. **US regulator definitions.** The TTB guidance PDF is image-only with no text layer; the $<0.5\%$ threshold was taken from two independent legal summaries. Drainable now by reading 27 CFR directly or running OCR.
6. **Non-alcoholic volume base and 2028 trajectory** (2.3% of 1.896bn hL today $\rightarrow$ ~4% by 2028). Vendor and trade-press derived; the underlying research is paywalled. *Estimate: 43.6m hL now, 70–82m hL 2028, probability 0.7.* The prize table is insensitive to this: even doubling 2028 volume leaves the required spend at ~€10/hL, which still returns only ~24% of enterprise value.
7. **Whether Kerry holds any non-alcoholic beer intellectual property.** Unknown — the register was down for all five runs, and neither bench will treat that outage as evidence. Drainable now by re-running against a working register. *Prior that a family exists: ~0.15.*
8. **Whether a listed options chain exists on this name at all.** Attempted this session; the broker call was denied on permissions. Drainable now with one call once permission is granted. *Estimate: probability a liquid single-name chain exists on an Irish-listed mid-cap: ~0.1.*

PRIZE TABLE + VOL READ

Required because item 1 above — the per-hectolitre repair spend — is genuinely private and time-gated. Anchored on the peer-reviewed repair list (commodity glycerol, mineral salts, yeast strain), which sits at the low end; probabilities are shaded above that anchor rather than below, and the shading is stated so it can be argued with.

Prize table (Kerry as a worldwide monopoly on the entire flavour layer, 2028 volumes of 76m hL, 25% margins, 20x):

Add-back captured	Layer revenue	Profit	Value created	% of €15.6bn enterprise value	Our probability
€2/hL	€152m	€38m	€0.76bn	4.9%	0.45
€5/hL	€380m	€95m	€1.90bn	12.2%	0.35
€10/hL	€760m	€190m	€3.80bn	24.4%	0.15
€20.5/hL	€1.56bn	€390m	€7.80bn	+50% (the bar)	0.05

Expected value line. Probability-weighted, the *monopoly* case is worth **12.6% of enterprise value**. Kerry is not a monopolist; against Givaudan, IFF, Symrise, Döhler, BarthHaas and the yeast houses, a realistic share is 8–15%, call it 12%. That gives **~1.5% of enterprise value = ~€234m = ~€1.47 per share ≈ +1.75% on the stock**.

Kerry's ordinary daily move is roughly 1.3%. **The entire thesis, weighted across every outcome including the impossible one, is worth about one and a third average trading days.** That is the whole case in one number.

Dispersion versus volatility. Converting the four branches to share-price terms at a 12% capture share gives +0.7%, +1.7%, +3.4%, +7.0%. The spread of those outcomes is **$\sigma_{\text{table}} \approx 1.5\%$** . A single quarter of ordinary movement in this stock, at ~20% annualised volatility, is **~10%**. The thesis's entire dispersion is roughly **one-seventh of one quarter's normal noise** — meaning no instrument can isolate it, because the signal is buried inside the stock's own drift.

Expression math, shown. Pricing a candidate 6.8%-out-of-the-money €90 call off the table itself: $C_{\text{ours}} = \sum p_i \times \max(S_i - 90, 0) = 0.05 \times \max(90.15 - 90, 0) = \text{€0.0075}$. Under a cent of thesis-attributable value. Any real €90 call would trade orders of magnitude above that, all of it paying for ordinary Kerry volatility we have no view on. Calls are refuted by the arithmetic, not by preference. Covered calls and cash-secured puts are moot at zero size. **Instrument recommendation, as the output of the arithmetic above: NONE.** And the chain almost certainly does not exist anyway — an Irish-listed mid-cap; that probe was denied on permissions this session and is carried as item 8, but it is not load-bearing, because the arithmetic rejects every options expression before the chain question is even asked. No implied-vs-realised volatility read and no volatility percentile are reported, because reporting them without a chain-level midpoint quote would be inventing them — the underlying aggregate volatility feed is the wrong number and has diverged badly before.

Tax overlay. No position, so no loss branch to land. Stated for the record because it would bind if adjudication reversed: 2026 is a harvesting year, so any expression whose losing branch resolves after 31 December would push the loss into 2027 and is excluded unless the edge numerically dominates — here the edge is +1.75% expected, so nothing dominates anything. Euro-funded; Irish dividend withholding tax documentation required before the 8 Oct ex-dividend; the position would start on a short-term clock.

Bottom line for the adjudicator. The mechanism is real and we understood it better than the market did. It does not matter. Two independent methods — share of retail value, and physical volume times spend per hectolitre — converge on the same answer: even perfect execution of this thesis is invisible inside Kerry. The defence bench's per-hectolitre inversion is the finding that should survive this deck and get generalised: for any "sell shovels to the gold rush" idea, solve for the spend per physical unit that the position requires, then ask whether that unit economic is physically possible. Here it is not, which is why the recommendation is to retire the idea rather than defer it — and why the separate question of whether Kerry is a good compounder at 15.7x deserves its own court, its own profitability test, and none of this ticket's history.

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ADJUDICATION STAMP — 2026-09-04 (FABLE) — NA-CHEMISTRY FAMILY RULING

THESIS REJECTED on all five chemistry-layer expressions; with the brewer courts this closes the NA-substitution FAMILY: seven expressions, three layers, seven deaths on the same denominator. Three independent instruments converge: the global purchased-chemistry pool for NA repair is \$11–55M (IFF benches); a full Kerry monopoly on it re-rates the equity 1.5–4.7% (the impossible case); GEA's monopoly-everything bull is 9% of group at its worst-margin division vs 0.9–1.8% demonstrated. Every FLAT is earned by named novel kills. Blue audits corrected three red financial cases — Givaudan is FAIR not expensive (RP_TAINTED was misapplied), Symrise's deceleration was a period-selection artifact, IFF looks better as a business post-audit — so four spin-off theses route to their own courts rather than inheriting this one: GIVN quality/TINA, SY1 compounder (alert €72), KRZ compounder (ROE gate), G1A industrial compounder (NPE +40% organic). Family reopens on: Athletic Brewing S-1, 2587.T Oceania disclosure (11/11 pack), G1A's 11/09 segment note ($\geq$ €110M brewing line — the one dated trigger), or any primary putting NA ingredient value $>$ \$8–24/hL. The yeast-supplier IP finding is the one new scout lead. SCIENCE stage maiden run: validated — all five briefs pre-empted the traps the brewer courts hit mid-argument. 13 KG detectors accepted, incl. the monopoly-capture/per-unit-breakeven prize-test pair ("price the roof before arguing the ladder"). Full ruling: [desk/data/court_artifacts/NA_CHEMISTRY_ADJUDICATION_202609040700.md](#).